

Mark Ratcliffe

MOVING · STORAGE

EDITION 2026 · OVERSEAS MOVING

The Complete Overseas Brochure

Your guide to international removals from Sussex.



BAR OVERSEAS GROUP · BS 8564 ACCREDITED · APG PROTECTED

TALK TO US

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Mark personally surveys every overseas move.

You speak to the same person from first call through to delivery.

01

Welcome to Mark Ratcliffe.

Thank you for downloading our overseas moving brochure. This document is the same one we hand to customers at our first survey meeting — a clear, no-jargon guide to how an international removal from Sussex actually works in practice.

We are a family-run, independent removals company operating from our Lower Dicker depot on the A22, just outside Eastbourne. We have been shipping British households around the world since 2017. Our team is small enough that the surveyor who visits your home is usually the same person you speak to throughout the move, and the office is answered by name in working hours.

On the international side, we are a member of the **British Association of Removers Overseas Group**, independently audited each year to **BS 8564** — the British Standard for international moving services — and every deposit you pay is protected under the **BAR Advance Payment Guarantee**.

2017

FOUNDED

120+

REVIEWS

4.9 / 5

AVG RATING

WHAT THIS BROCHURE COVERS

Process · destinations · customs paperwork · realistic timelines · what to ship · how pricing works · FAQs
· how to book your free survey.

How the 8-step process works

Every overseas move follows the same eight-stage rhythm. Knowing what comes next removes most of the uncertainty.

1

Free survey

In-home or video, 45–60 minutes. Walk every room, identify special items, confirm timing.

2

Quote within 48 hours

Fixed-price, itemised, valid 30 days. Includes UK pack, freight, customs, destination delivery.

3

Booking + deposit

25% deposit secures the date. Protected under the BAR Advance Payment Guarantee.

4

Pre-pack + packing

Materials delivered ahead. Full-pack or fragile-only options. Export-grade pad-wrap.

5

Load day

Crew arrives 08:00–09:00, in uniform. Pad-wrap, load and seal the container in your driveway.

6

UK customs + shipping

Sevington customs (EU) or port handling (sea). Fortnightly position updates during the voyage.

7

Destination delivery

Customs cleared against your ToR1. Agent crew unloads, places furniture, removes pad-wrap.

8

Follow-up

Call within a week of delivery. Insurance claim filed within 14 days if needed.

Destinations we cover

We move households worldwide. These are the destinations we handle most often from Sussex, each with its own dedicated process and vetted destination agent.

France

All regions. Channel Tunnel or ferry. 5–10 days.

Spain

Costas, Catalonia, Andalucía, Balearics. 7–12 days.

Italy / Portugal

Tuscany, Algarve, Lisbon, Porto. 8–14 days.

USA & Canada

NYC, LA, Toronto, Vancouver. ISF 10+2. 6–10 weeks.

Australia / NZ

Sydney, Melbourne, Perth, Auckland. AQIS / MPI. 10–14 weeks.

UAE

Dubai, Abu Dhabi. Air or sea. 4–6 weeks.

South Africa

Cape Town, Joburg, Durban. SARS P1.160. 10–13 weeks.

Thailand

Bangkok, Phuket, Chiang Mai. UK-Thai group. 10–13 weeks.

Beyond

Singapore, HK, Caribbean, Latin America. Quoted on request.

ON EVERY DESTINATION

Vetted destination agent in country · BAR Code of Practice · APG-protected deposit · marine transit insurance arranged via specialist Lloyd's broker.

Customs paperwork

The single biggest cause of delays and unexpected costs on international moves is paperwork. We handle all of it as standard.

TOR1 — TRANSFER OF RESIDENCE RELIEF

ToR1 is the customs scheme that lets people moving their main residence import household goods without paying import VAT or duty. Four conditions apply:

- 1 Moving your normal place of residence
- 2 Owned + used items for 6+ months
- 3 Will live in destination 12+ months
- 4 ToR1 filed 14 days before arrival

COST OF GETTING TOR1 WRONG

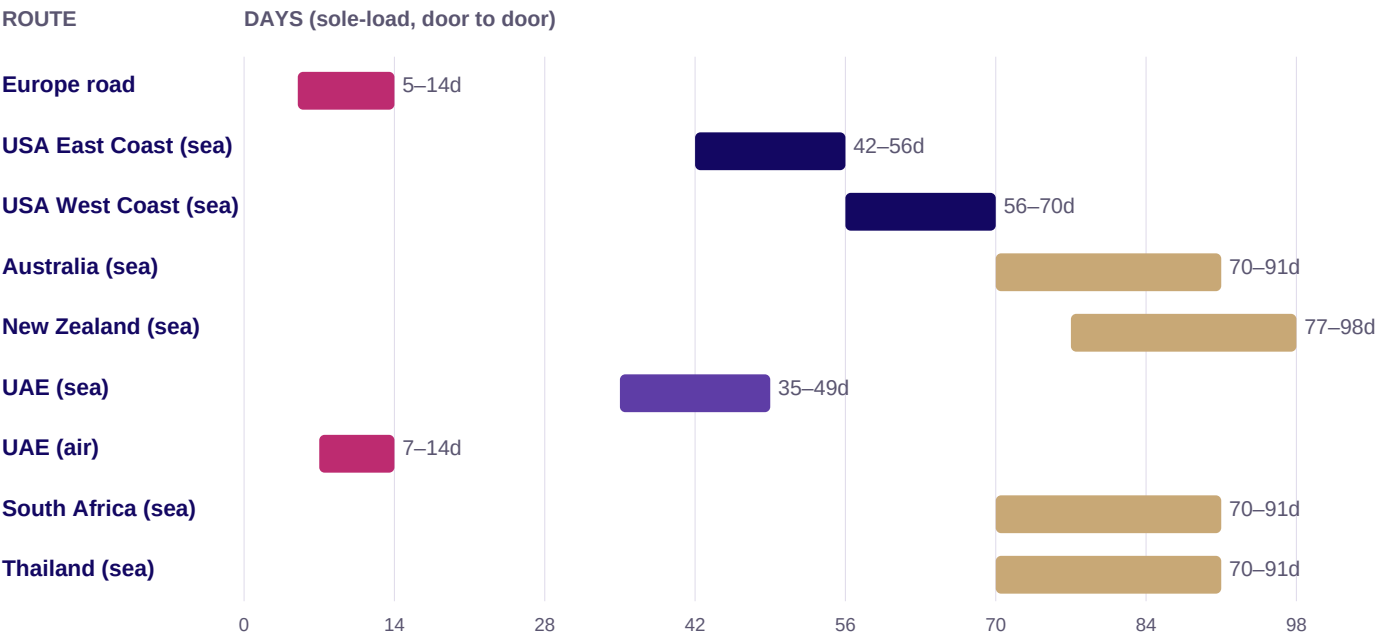
Typically 20–25% of the declared value of your goods in import VAT and duty — a multi-thousand-pound penalty for missing paperwork. We file ToR1 for every eligible mover as standard.

COUNTRY-SPECIFIC ENTRY DOCUMENTS

- France — DAU (Document Administratif Unique)
- Spain — DUA + your NIE foreigner ID number
- USA — ISF 10+2 (mandatory, \$5,000 penalty per violation) + Form 3299
- Canada — Form B4 Personal Effects Accounting Document
- Australia — AQIS biosecurity + ISPM-15 wood stamp
- New Zealand — MPI biosecurity (similarly strict)
- UAE — Residency visa + Emirates ID required for release
- South Africa — SARS Form P1.160 personal-effects rebate
- Thailand — Customs declaration via UK-Thai Movers Group agent

Realistic timelines

Door-to-door for a typical 3-bed household, sole-load. Part-loads add 2–7 days for European road; 2–4 weeks for sea-freight consolidation.



WHAT CAN STRETCH THE TIMELINE

- **Part-load (groupage)**
30–50% cheaper but adds days to weeks waiting for consolidation
- **Destination customs**
Usually 5–14 days; rare to exceed 21 days with good paperwork
- **Biosecurity treatment (AU/NZ)**
Adds 7–21 days if any outdoor items are contaminated
- **Visa / residency delays**
We can bond goods at port for up to 30 days while you wait

What to ship — and what to leave

Not everything in your UK home is worth shipping overseas. At the survey we tell you honestly what is worth the freight and what is cheaper to replace at destination.

✓ WORTH SHIPPING	~ OFTEN NOT WORTH	✗ NEVER SHIP
• Quality furniture, especially antiques • Framed art & mirrors • Books & vinyl • China, glass, silverware • Pianos (specialist crew) • Wine collections (where ToR1 allows) • Clothes & linens • Children's items	• 13-amp UK kitchen appliances • Fitted kitchens / wardrobes • Mattresses (often replace) • Plants (biosecurity) • Food (prohibited most countries) • Paint / fuel / chemicals • Modern cars to USA / Australia	• Firearms (without permit) • Narcotics (incl. some UK prescriptions) • Alcohol in large quantities • Material critical of destination • Untreated solid wood (AU, NZ, USA, EU) • Soil, plants, seeds (AU/NZ)

How pricing works

Every overseas quote is fixed-price after the free survey. The figure we send is the figure you pay — no volumetric clauses, no surprise destination fees.

WHAT IS INCLUDED AS STANDARD

- ✓ Survey + planning

✓ UK packing crew

✓ Sea or road freight

✓ Destination crew + delivery
- ✓ Customs paperwork incl. ToR1

✓ Road haulage to UK port

✓ Port handling

✓ Furniture placement
- ✓ Export-grade materials

✓ Container / lorry hire

✓ Destination customs entry

✓ Pad-wrap removal

2026 PRICE RANGES (SOLE-LOAD, ALL-IN)

ROUTE	FROM	TO	NOTES
Europe road (3-bed)	£3,500	£7,500	France / Spain / Italy / Portugal
USA / Canada 20-ft container	£5,800	£8,800	NYC, LA, Vancouver, Toronto
USA / Canada 40-ft container	£8,000	£13,000	Larger family households
Australia / NZ 20-ft container	£6,500	£9,500	Sydney, Melbourne, Auckland
Australia / NZ 40-ft container	£8,500	£13,500	Full 3–4 bed households
UAE 20-ft container	£5,500	£8,000	Dubai, Abu Dhabi
South Africa 20-ft container	£5,200	£7,800	Cape Town, Durban
Thailand 20-ft container	£5,500	£8,200	Bangkok and beyond
LCL shared sea freight	£170/m³	£260/m³	Smaller volumes — slower
Air freight (≤3 m³)	£4,500	£8,000+	Time-critical essentials only

Frequently asked questions

Q. 01**How far in advance should I book?**

Europe: 4–6 weeks. Sea-freight (AU/USA/UAE/SA/Thailand): 8–12 weeks so we can book the container into a suitable sailing.

Q. 02**Do I need to be there on packing day?**

For the initial walkthrough yes. After that, many customers leave; keys can be handed to a neighbour or letting agent.

Q. 03
Can my car go in the container with my household?

Sometimes — depends on destination rules. We usually recommend a specialist vehicle-shipper to keep import regs clean.

Q. 04**Is my deposit safe?**

Yes — every deposit is protected under the BAR Advance Payment Guarantee. If the firm couldn't fulfil, the APG refunds in full.

Q. 05**What insurance is included?**

Standard transit cover for major loss is included. Comprehensive marine transit insurance is recommended for international moves (2–3% of declared value).

Q. 06**What if my completion slips?**

Common. We hold goods at destination bonded warehouse (~£150–£300/wk) or our Lower Dicker depot in steel strong rooms.

Q. 07**Will you handle the customs paperwork?**

Yes — included as standard. We file ToR1 14 days before shipment + destination customs entry via our agent.

Q. 08**Can I send wine to my new home?**

Most of Europe yes (declared on inventory). Australia, NZ, UAE: specific permits required; often not worth the cost.

Why choose Mark Ratcliffe Moving

Most moves go fine regardless of who you book. The difference shows up at the edges — tight access, slipped completions, awkward customs questions, items that arrive needing attention. That is where having an owner-managed, accredited firm matters.

FAMILY-RUN

Founded 2017. Owner-managed since day one. No franchise, no national chain hierarchy. Mark is on the phone.

BAR MEMBER

British Association of Removers Overseas Group. Annual independent audit. Code of Practice binding. Verifiable at bar.co.uk.

BS 8564

British Standard for international moving. UKAS-accredited certification body. Documented quality-management system.

APG-PROTECTED

Every deposit protected by the BAR Advance Payment Guarantee. Refunded in full if anything goes wrong.



*Mark personally surveys every overseas move,
and our average customer review sits at 4.9 / 5.*

— 120+ reviews across Google, Trustpilot and BAR

NEXT STEP

Talk to us.

Free survey. Quote within 48 hours. Fixed-price.

PHONE

01323 848 008

Mon–Fri 08:00–17:30 · Sat 09:00–13:00

EMAIL

office@markratcliffemoving.co.uk

Reply within 1 working day

VISIT

Lower Dicker depot

Unit J12 Swallow Business Park, Diamond Drive, BN27 4EL

ONLINE

markratcliffemoving.co.uk

Free instant estimate + online quote form

Book your free overseas survey

No obligation. Quote within 48 hours.

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